

How We'll Know the Safety Orientation Worked

A four-level evaluation plan for *Last Light*, using things a small production already has.

Owner: 1st AD (Chris Bell) **Reports to:** producer (Sam Ortiz) **Covers:** the [Set Safety Orientation](#), taken by everyone before day 1

Shoot: 18 days

Purpose

The orientation exists to change what people do on set: cover cable, bag stands, foot ladders, keep exits clear, call holds and report near misses. Knowing the rules is necessary but not the goal. This plan checks all four levels, but it is built around Level 3, behaviour on set, because that's where the training either works or doesn't.

Summary

LEVEL	QUESTION	MEASURE	WHEN	TARGET
1 Reaction	Was it useful and believable?	3-question survey	End of the course, before day 1	Average 4 of 5 or higher on "I'd call a hold"
2 Learning	Do people know the rules?	Knowledge check; hazard hunt	End of the course, before day 1	Everyone passes (7 of 8); average 6 of 8 hazards found before using "Show me"
3 Behaviour	Do people do it on set?	Set-walk checklist; holds called for safety	Days 1, 3 and 10, at call and after each company move	90% of checklist items met by day 3, held through day 10
4 Results	Is the set safer?	Injuries; near misses reported; time lost to safety incidents	Weekly, and at wrap	Zero lost-time injuries; near-miss reports rise in week 1, then fall

LEVEL 1 REACTION

Did people find it useful?

INSTRUMENT	Three questions at the end of the course, each on a 1–5 scale: "This was relevant to the work I'll be doing on this show." "The rules were clear enough to follow on set." "If I saw something unsafe, I would call a hold."
TARGET	Average 4 or higher on question 3. It's the reaction that matters most, because it predicts whether people will speak up.
ACTING ON IT	Low scores on question 3 go into the day 1 safety meeting: the 1st AD says plainly that holds are welcome and thanks the first person who calls one.

Do people know the rules?

INSTRUMENTS	The 8-question knowledge check (pass mark 7), and the hazard hunt: how many of the eight hazards each person finds before using "Show me".
TARGET	Everyone passes before their first call. Average hunt score of 6 or more.
ACTING ON IT	Any question more than a quarter of people miss is rewritten, or its lesson is. The hazard most often missed becomes the first thing the 1st AD points out on the day 1 set walk.

Do people do it on set?

INSTRUMENT	A 10-minute set walk by the 1st AD with the key PA, at call and after each company move, using the checklist below. Plus a tally of holds called for safety, kept on the production report.
WHEN	Days 1, 3 and 10. Day 1 is the baseline, day 3 shows whether it took, and day 10 shows whether it lasted.
TARGET	90% of checklist items met by day 3, and still met on day 10.

SET-WALK CHECKLIST	MET?
Cable crossing walkways and doorways is under a mat or a ramp	☐
Every stand with an arm out is bagged on the high leg	☐
Every ladder in use has someone footing it	☐
Fire exits and the route to them are clear	☐
First aid kit is visible and stocked	☐
No cable or connection in water; rain plan followed if wet	☐
Hot lights are out of walkways or flagged	☐
Generator keep-clear zone is clear	☐
Crew calls ("Points", "Watch your back", "Striking") heard during the walk	☐
Specialist work (cars, stunts, effects, weapons) had a safety meeting first	☐

WHY BEHAVIOUR COMES FIRST

A crew can pass the knowledge check and still run cable across a doorway at 6 a.m. The set walk is the only measure here that shows the training working where it matters.

Is the set safer?

MEASURES	Injuries from the incident log, split into first-aid-only and lost-time. Near misses reported per week. Time lost to safety incidents, from the production report.
TARGET	Zero lost-time injuries. Near-miss reports rise in week 1, then fall.
READING IT	A training that works makes people report more at first, not less. A low near-miss count in week 1 would mean people aren't reporting, not that the set is safe. The fall afterwards is the sign that hazards are being fixed.

Timeline

WHEN	WHAT	WHO
Before day 1	Everyone takes the orientation; reaction and knowledge results collected	Production office, 1st AD
Day 1	Safety meeting at call; baseline set walk	1st AD, key PA
Day 3	Second set walk; first one-page report to the producer	1st AD
Day 10	Third set walk; check that behaviour held	1st AD, key PA
Weekly	Incident and near-miss totals; time lost	1st AD to producer
Wrap	Wrap report: all four levels, what changed in the course, and what to keep for the next show	1st AD to producer

Limits, and what it costs

- **No control group.** One show can't compare trained and untrained crews. If the production company kept an incident log on its last show, compare against that, and check whether the behaviours seen on set are the ones the course taught.
- **Small numbers.** With a crew of about 40, one incident moves the numbers a lot. Read Level 4 as a story, not a rate.
- **Cost.** Nothing new to buy: the course, a printed checklist, the incident log and the production report. About 10 minutes of the 1st AD's time on three days, and a one-page weekly report.